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VENTURE



Iconiq's Will Griffith
explains how his firm
celebrated Figma's IPO
and why investors sold
shares

Will Griffith had only been two months in his job as a venture investor for Iconiq when he met a 19-year-old college dropout named Dylan Field. This would lead to one of his signature seed investments, in a startup called Figma.

On Thursday, [Figma went public with the stock popping](#) from the \$33 IPO opening price to close at \$115.50 and a \$47 billion market cap. And Griffith could not be more effusive in his praise for the company.

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“You go to one of these user conferences and you’re like, there’s 15,000 people here and 5,000 have Figma tattoos,” Griffith smiled. From the earliest days, the founders of this company that offers software for designers had “a fervent desire to win and deliver and redefine this ecosystem.”

Yet in 2013 at that first meeting, co-founders Dylan Field and Evan Wallace were untested. And at that point, so was Iconiq. It was known then as the very secretive wealth management firm for many of Silicon Valley’s richest tech moguls, like Mark Zuckerberg and Jack Dorsey.

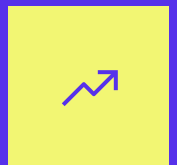
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Figma, however, already had a champion: Field had been an intern at LinkedIn under its then CEO Jeff Weiner. Weiner was an angel investor (and bought more [stock at later rounds](#), too) and introduced Field to Griffith.

“We got connected to Figma before we had an early fund, before we had any venture fund,” Griffith told TechCrunch. The investor remembers trekking out to meet the founders. “It was like two guys and the dog in an apartment in Palo Alto, and they were working on these newfangled graphics and design capability in a browser.”

The demo showed how light could be manipulated when editing a photo in a browser. At the time, browser-based design software, based on WebGL, was revolutionary. Tech giant Adobe had the graphics design market locked up with its desktop software. “I thought it was insane,” Griffith recalled.

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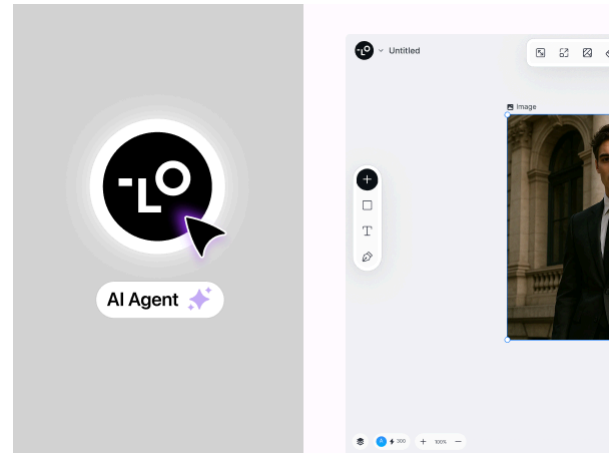
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The idea was so unproven Alexis Ohanian, who was investing out of his then firm Initialized, passed on

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Figma when he saw the product years later in 2016, he noted in [a tweet this week](#). Ohanian called Figma a member of his “embarrassing miss-list.”

But Griffith wrote a check. Seed shares, by the way, were priced at \$0.0878 each, Figma [disclosed](#) in its S-1A. And Griffith wrote more checks as Figma raised additional rounds. The company raised a total of about \$332 million in venture funding through 2024, PitchBook estimates.

“We invested in the seed. We invested in the Series A. We invested further. We did some secondary and we also invested more meaningfully a year ago,” Griffith said.

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Iconiq did not wind up owning at least 5% of the company, a bar that would require Figma to publicly disclose the size of its stake. But it owns enough that the IPO will be celebrated at the Iconiq offices.

“One of the ways that we celebrate is we guess what the closing day stock price is going to be on the first day. It’s a prediction contest around the firm,” Griffith said. “There are some good prizes and rewards.” If someone nails that number, they could wind up with a healthy cash bonus or even something like a trip to Hawaii.

As for the odd part of this IPO, Griffith has some insight. Most of the stock sold was [from investors’ stakes, including Field’s](#), rather than new shares issued by the company, the company said.

“I think it’s very generous that existing investors are willing to sell as much to create enough supply for this IPO,” he said.

Figma's fundamentals are so solid that the [IPO was 40 times oversubscribed](#), according to Bloomberg, meaning far more investors wanted shares than the supply available.

That can be almost as problematic as investor disinterest, Griffith explained. The largest institutional investors won't bother with an IPO where they can't trade hundreds of millions' worth of shares, he said. And if an IPO doesn't float enough shares, prices of available shares could become artificially inflated, meaning the company won't be properly valued. Should prices decline after opening day, the company could be artificially devalued as well.

Figma's existing shareholders didn't really want to sell shares at \$33, Griffith said. "We have been with this business since 2015, and we haven't sold a share. And we are going to be meaningful buyers in the IPO," he said.

Still, Griffith emphasized that for Figma, IPO day is just a milestone and not an end. "I met a young, 19-year-old Dylan, and we forged a partnership," he said. He describes himself as "proud" of seeing Field, Figma's CEO, "continue to just mature and grow, but have the same vision, morals, authenticity."

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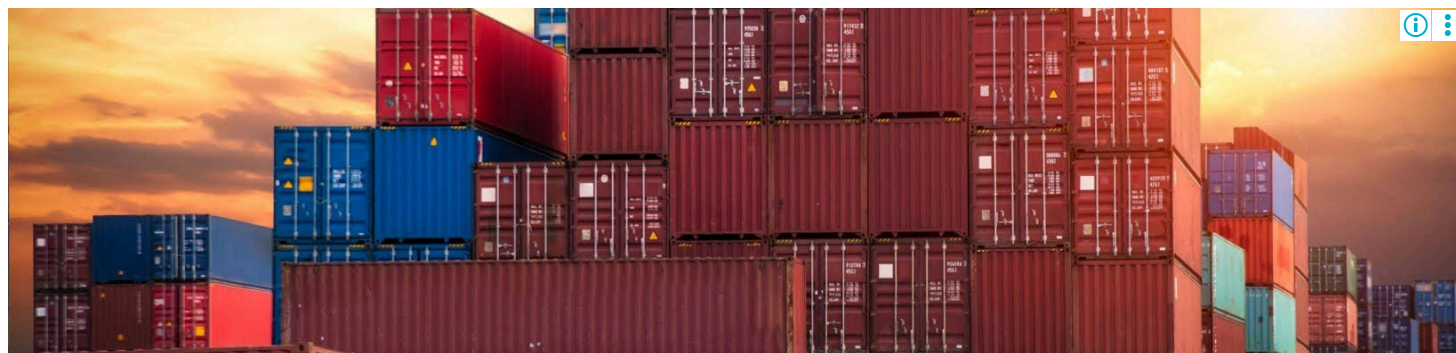


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In the meantime, he says he'll be spending Figma's IPO day "meeting with the next generation of founders."

Topics: [Figma](#) [iconiq capital](#) [IPOs 2025](#) [seed capital](#)



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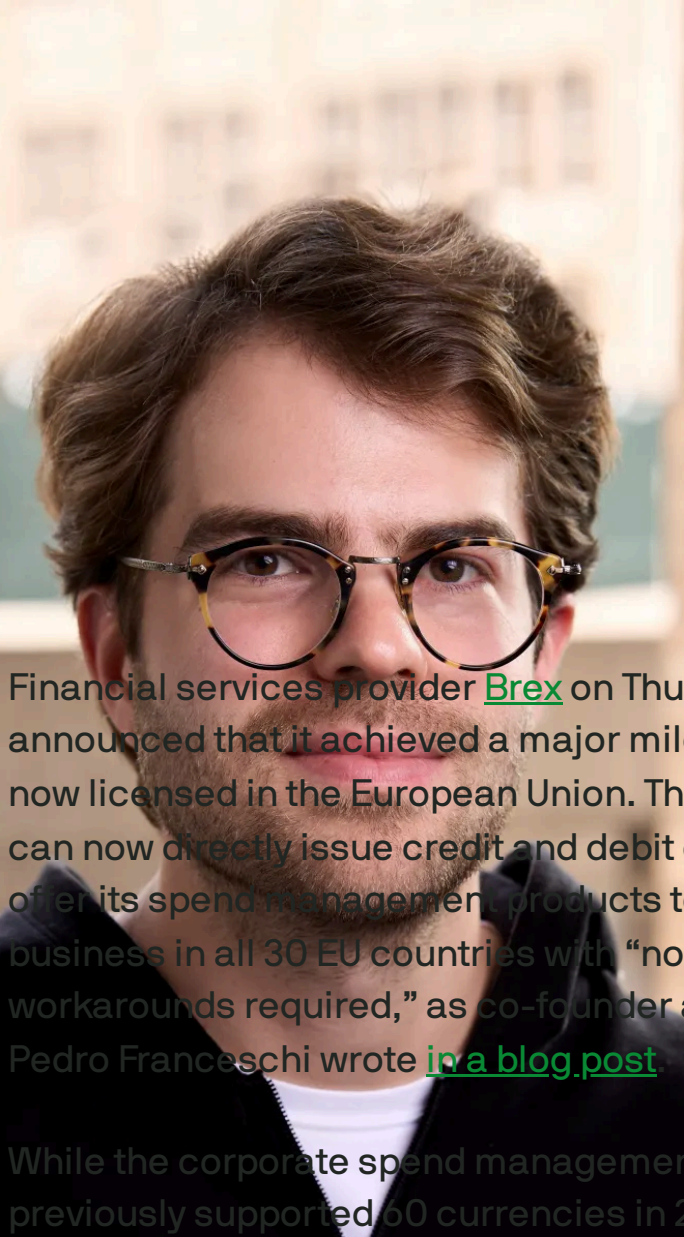
FINTECH



IPO hopeful Brex scored major win to sell in the

EU, plans UK expansion

Julie Bort — 11:52 AM PDT · August 7, 2025



Financial services provider [Brex](#) on Thursday announced that it achieved a major milestone: It is now licensed in the European Union. That means it can now directly issue credit and debit cards and offer its spend management products to any business in all 30 EU countries with “no workarounds required,” as co-founder and CEO Pedro Franceschi wrote [in a blog post](#).

While the corporate spend management startup previously supported 60 currencies in 200 countries, it could only sell its products to companies with a U.S. presence.

With the expansion, Brex is now authorized to sell spend management (complete with issuing cards) and other tools like embedded payments to EU companies and startups, a spokesperson tells TechCrunch. However, there’s a caveat: Banking and bill pay will not be initially available. The company hopes to roll those services out in the future.

While this is good news for Brex, it may also be good news for European startups. Brex’s claim to fame is offering startups expense management cards for their employees even if they wouldn’t yet qualify from traditional banks. Without a bank account offering, the youngest EU startups will still have to weigh their options.

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Next up, Franceschi says he wants to expand Brex in the U.K., though he offered no specifics on those plans.

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Franceschi [said in December](#) that Brex is on track to stop burning cash in 2025, “an important milestone to our future IPO.”

In February, sources told various news outlets that Brex was on track for \$500 million in revenue this year as well. That’s quite the turnaround from a shaky moment in 2023 when Brex conducted layoffs and reportedly told employees that its cash burn was too high. There has been no hint yet as to when that IPO may take place, though.

Brex’s competitive win in the international market comes as its U.S. fintech competitors are having an overall moment. Ramp has been raising money from VCs like mad, [hitting a \\$22.5 billion valuation just 45 days](#) after a round with a \$16 billion valuation. In March, [Mercury raised a fresh \\$300 million](#) and doubled its valuation to \$3.5 billion.

Brex has not publicly announced new equity VC funding since 2022, when it raised \$300 million in a [Series D-2 round at a \\$12.3 billion](#) valuation. It did, however, sell a fresh \$260 million of bonds in [March 2024](#), packaged from its spend management receivables which are used to manage that cash-intensive business.

Topics: [Brex](#) [european startups](#) [Fintech](#)

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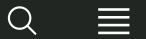
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Elad Gil isn't just ahead of the curve — he practically lives there. Before most of the world had even asked ChatGPT its first question, Gil was writing early checks into companies like Perplexity, Character.AI, and Harvey. And that's just a slice of the story. His track record includes seed or Series A investments in more than 30 unicorns and involvement with some of the most iconic names in tech — Stripe, Airbnb, Coinbase, Instacart, Notion, Figma, Flexport, GitLab, and many more.

This October, Gil takes the [Disrupt Stage](#) at [TechCrunch Disrupt 2025](#) in San Francisco for a fireside chat that promises to cover a lot of ground. He'll cover everything from his approach to spotting breakout potential early to how he's thinking about the next big wave of innovation. Whether you're building in AI, crypto, health tech, or enterprise SaaS, this conversation is a rare opportunity to hear how one of Silicon Valley's most prolific investors sees the road ahead.

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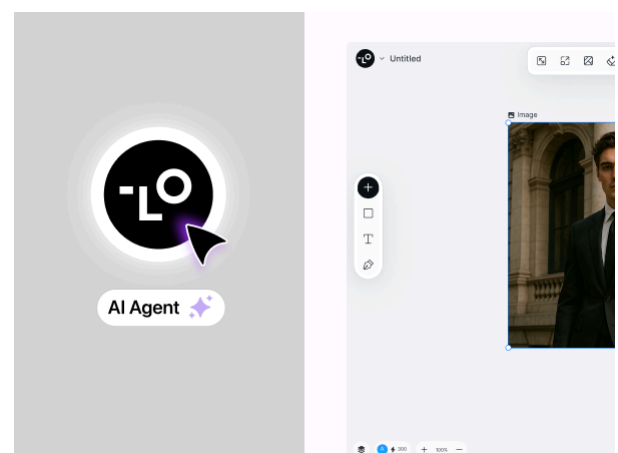
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Why this one matters

There are VCs, and then there's [Elad Gil](#). With operating experience at Google and Twitter, multiple founder wins, and a portfolio that reads like a who's who of tech success stories, he brings a rare mix of operator empathy and investor clarity. His bestselling book "High Growth Handbook" is required reading for startup leaders scaling fast, and his ability to decode markets before they shift is second to none.

In this one-on-one, we'll go deep on early-stage investing, new frontier technologies, and what it really takes to build a category-defining company. From the inside out.

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TechCrunch Events — 11:48 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

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From pitch to partnership: The real roadmap to seed funding

This dynamic panel brings together three seasoned investors — Maria Palma (Freestyle Capital), Gabby Cazeau (Harlem Capital), and Marlon Nichols (MaC Venture Capital) — to unpack the realities of early-stage fundraising. From shaping a compelling pitch to choosing the right capital partners, they'll share honest, actionable insights to help founders translate interest into investment.

[Maria Palma](#), general partner at [Freestyle Capital](#), brings deep operating and investing experience, with past roles at Kindred Capital, RRE Ventures, and leadership positions at high-growth startups like Eyeview. She's backed companies such as Fung Money, Lightning Labs, and Payman, and holds an MBA from Harvard.

[Gabby Cazeau](#) is a partner at [Harlem Capital](#), investing in pre-seed and seed startups across enterprise software and applied AI. She holds an MBA from Yale and a BS in chemical engineering. Gabby has been featured in Business Insider, CNBC, and Crain's 40 Under 40, and serves on the VC Council of Startup:NYC.

[Marlon Nichols](#), co-founder and managing general partner of [MaC Venture Capital](#), leads one of North America's top seed-stage firms with over \$600

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million AUM (assets under management). A multiple-time honoree on Business Insider's Seed 100 and PitchBook's list of top Black VCs, Marlon has helped scale industry-shaping companies like Blavity, Thrive Market, and MongoDB.

What to expect on the Builders Stage

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